



INSTRUCTIONAL AREA

Communication Skills

HUMAN RESOURCES MANAGEMENT SERIES EVENT

PARTICIPANT INSTRUCTIONS

(quoted directly from DECA, INC)

- "The event will be presented to you through your reading of the 21st Century Skills, Performance Indicators and Case Study Situation. You will have up to 10 minutes to review this information and prepare your presentation. You may make notes to use during your presentation."
- "You will have up to 10 minutes to make your presentation to the judge (you may have more than one judge)."
- "You will be evaluated on how well you meet the performance indicators of this event."
- "Turn in all of your notes and event materials when you have completed the event."

21st CENTURY SKILLS

- Critical Thinking – Reason effectively and use systems thinking.
- Communication – Communicate clearly.
- Creativity and Innovation – Show evidence of creativity.

PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

1. Explain the nature of effective written communications.
2. Explain how digital communications exposes business to risk.
3. Explain the nature of staff communication.
4. Choose and use appropriate channels for workplace communication.
5. Distinguish between using social media for business and personal purposes.

EVENT SITUATION

You are to assume the role of Human Resources Manager for BRIGHT LIGHTS MARKETING, a mid-sized marketing firm. The CEO (judge) has asked you to create a social media policy for employees to mitigate risk and maintain a positive online presence for the firm.

BRIGHT LIGHTS MARKETING is experiencing significant growth and has hired many new employees in the last six months. The company's social media presence is minimal, but the CEO (judge) wants to focus on growing online engagement. The firm utilizes several social media platforms, including Facebook, Instagram, Twitter, and LinkedIn. The company does not have any current policies regarding social media use by employees.

The CEO (judge) is concerned about the potential risks associated with employees posting on social media. These risks could include:

- **Reputational Damage:** Negative comments or inappropriate content posted by employees can harm the firm's reputation and deter potential clients.
- **Legal Issues:** Employees disclosing confidential information or making discriminatory remarks could result in lawsuits.
- **Security Breaches:** Employees inadvertently revealing sensitive company information could create vulnerabilities for hackers.

The CEO (judge) has asked you to develop a comprehensive social media policy that addresses these concerns and outlines clear guidelines for employee conduct on social media. The policy should:

- Define acceptable and unacceptable online behavior.
- Establish clear consequences for violations.
- Provide examples of appropriate and inappropriate social media posts.

You will present your proposed social media policy to the CEO (judge) in a meeting to take place in the CEO's office. The CEO (judge) will begin the meeting by greeting you and asking to hear your ideas. After you have presented your policy and answered the CEO's (judge's) questions, the CEO (judge) will conclude the meeting by thanking you for your work.

Possible Judge's Questions:

1. How will this policy affect employee morale, and what steps can we take to ensure a smooth implementation?
2. How do we balance employee freedom of speech with the need to protect our company's reputation online?

Did the participant:		Novice	Developing	Proficient	Exemplary	Judged Score
PERFORMANCE INDICATORS						
1.	Explain the nature of effective written communications?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
2.	Explain how digital communications exposes business to risk?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
3.	Explain the nature of staff communication?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
4.	Choose and use appropriate channels for workplace communication?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
5.	Distinguish between using social media for business and personal purposes?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
SOLUTION						
6.	Unique– Demonstrates original thinking, fresh perspectives, and an insightful approach.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
7.	Practical– Actionable/viable in a real-world context.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
8.	Effective– Achieves relevant outcomes.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
CAREER COMPETENCIES						
9.	Critical Thinking– Thinks critically to understand and solve problems.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
10.	Communication– Communicates clearly, effectively, and with reason.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
11.	Decision-making– Considers the impacts of decisions.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
OVERALL IMPRESSION						
12.	Overall impression– The degree to which the presentation leaves a lasting impression.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
TOTAL SCORE						